Teacher and cover planner

Choose and try a calm step

Wednesday 20 January 2027 · P1 · 40 minutes · Year A

BUILD · three to four learners · Spring 1 Week 3 · formative

Theme Resilience & Change. Six-week term; Week 6 assessing.

Thread tags: SMSC S/So (M/C none); British Values IL/MR (D/RL/T none).

Exact source outcome

Use a calming strategy independently.

Source: BUILD Weekly - Spring, PSHE & Citizenship, row 66. B66 Spr1·W3 and C66 exact. Named framework/resource context generic; no accreditation or therapeutic claim.

What this lesson teaches

Teach three short, school-agreed routines: soft breath, look and count, small hand move. Learner chooses one, tries the steps with usual access after a general cue, and gives their own Did it help? feedback. Independence means no adult next-step content prompts, not removal of a card or aids. A pass/stop/switch is respected and recorded honestly.

Prepare

Books, three routine cards, the single-page keep card in Support Cards page 4, vocabulary and staff evidence record. Adult-operated familiar quiet visual timer with no alarm, set only after choice/setup. Confirm safe usual positions, existing sensory/physical adaptations and private help. No distress induction or personal trigger questions. No new breath-rate/count protocol.

Source and calendar

Wednesday 20 January 2027 P1, Year A. Week range 18–22 January; six-week Spring 1, Week 6 assessing. Owner supplies timetable. C66 exact; identifying source resource labels generic. This is low-pressure practice, not treatment or a health assessment.

Where this leads

This helps me choose a safe routine, use agreed aids and say whether a step helped during learning or future work.

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Forty minute sequence

Chunk	Minutes	Teaching
Chunk 1	0–12	3 calm arrival; 4 words/choice; 4 breath model; 1 reset.
Chunk 2	12–25	6 count/move teaching; 3 private hinge; 3 choose/plan; 1 reset.
Chunk 3	25–40	9 private timed practice/check; 3 feedback; 3 private exit.

Chunks last 12, 13 and 15 minutes. Two one-minute resets are included. Practice is one optional quiet try of up to 30 seconds, not a thirty-second breathing cycle. No race, minimum time or requirement to complete all routines. Reduce repetitions for access.

Chunk 1

0–3 calm starter: story A and choice of a card; no current-feeling question. 3–7 pre-teach card/help/stop, three choices, pass/stop/switch and own feedback. 7–11 teach soft breath one short step at a time with the IN/OUT image, exact written steps and visible model. Soft breath at comfortable personal pace; no hold or phase counts. Privately check IN/OUT; supported rehearsal is teaching, not independent evidence. 11–12 reset.

Chunk 2

12–18 teach look-and-count 3 see/2 safe contact points/1 sound, eyes open, and the small seated hand movement. Use normal environment and usual access; no touching another person, forced sensation or movement demand. 18–21 main hinge B: card/usual aids can stay without adult next-step cues; false A removes all aids. Parallel A: No/Not sure is valid own feedback, not failure. 21–24 choose/plan one routine with Level 2 bank/starter/model. 24–25 reset.

Chunk 3

25–34 private choice/setup, one quiet practice of up to 30 seconds and brief own check. General cue: choose a card and try its steps if you wish. Adult runs timer without giving the next content step. Observe actual chosen practice, access and prompts; no copied model or scribe can replace it. Stop earlier/pass/switch respected; missing practice stays unobserved. 34–37 one next step and response. 37–40 private exit and own Did it help? choice; keep the card in book/usual accessible place.

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Scaffolds and response routes

Level 2 on every task

All seven tasks keep a short bank, starter and visible worked model: Starter, Model check, Guided count and move, Private hinge, Choose and plan, Timed practice and check, Feedback and exit. They appear on Support Cards pages 5–6. Independent work retains aids; the learner supplies the routine actions rather than adult next-step instructions.

Supported

Teach one short step at a time first. Keep word bank, sentence starter, visible model and routine card. Offer two routine choices if needed. Usual aid or exact scribe records choice/check; actual practice remains the learner's. Record all adult step prompts faithfully.

Independent

Keep the chosen routine card, bank, starter and visible model. After the general task cue, learner chooses, starts and uses the steps without adult step instructions. Usual sensory, physical, reading, timer or communication access remains. Record actual practice and their own help tick.

Aspire

Keep all Level 2 aids. Use one chosen routine, then explain whether it helped or what to try next. More writing or trying all three is not required. Independence means no adult next-step cues, not removal of normal aids.

Worked example and fade

Use invented A: chosen soft breath, IN then OUT at own pace, no hold. Keep step card and model visible. Teach/rehearse with adult prompts first if needed, recording that as teaching/support. For the later observed try give a general task cue and fade content prompts only; do not remove routine card, reading/sensory/physical aids or quiet timer access.

Scribed route

Exact scribe can record a selected card, own helpfulness feedback or next step, read back and permit correction. It cannot perform the routine or turn a spoken/drawn explanation into evidence of actual use. Record observed action and any gap honestly; no health or breath-depth judgement.

Prompt ladder and TA focus

1 Point to place/instruction. 2 Ask a short question privately. 3 Rephrase. 4 Offer scaffold/choice. 5 Model first step only, then return task. Allow processing. These content prompts support learning, but actual next-step prompts during practice must be logged and prevent an unsupported independent-use claim. Normal access remains separate.

Book first

Routine cards are reference material. The dedicated page-4 keep card has a blank choice and four unticked Did it help? choices for the learner's own mark/selection; keep in book/usual accessible place. This tick card is intentional. Other responses use book/usual aid. Plan in any language.

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Checks access and private help

Check after the model

IN means a soft breath in; OUT a soft breath out. Own slow comfortable pace, no hold or timed breath phases. No forced deep breath. Learner can stop/change/seek help. Use bank/start/model and private pointing or aid.

Main and parallel hinge

Main B: the chosen card and usual aids may stay; adult does not give each next content step. False A says all aids must be removed. Parallel A: No or Not sure to Did it help? is valid feedback; false B treats it as failure. Re-model/recheck privately; a pass remains unobserved. A useful try need not produce Yes.

Planned adaptations

Cognition and Learning: four short routine steps, visible cue, one chosen option and reduced repetition. Communication and Interaction: wait time, familiar aid, pointing/selected feedback, exact scribe/readback. SEMH: calm stories, private choice, pass/stop/switch and supported return. Sensory and Physical: usual safe position and existing aids/adaptations; avoid uncomfortable sensation/movement, choose another card if needed. EAL: plan in any language. Colour is not the sole cue.

Private help route

Point to HELP, write or ask to talk in private with a trusted adult through the school's help route. If one adult is busy, use the route to another. Pass, pause and supported return available.

Staff response

If a pupil discloses, listen calmly, reassure and pass the concern to the safeguarding lead through the school's procedure. Do not probe or promise secrecy. Keep details out of this pack and shared evidence.

Misconceptions

Independent means no card: correction keep normal aids, record next-step prompts. The timer sets breath rate: correction timer bounds an optional try only. Calming must work or get Yes: correction all four feedback options valid. An explanation proves actual use: correction observe chosen practice or record unobserved. Do not induce a big feeling or grade calm appearance.

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Evidence and feedback

What to keep

Actual chosen routine, general cue, start/steps seen, duration/stop, usual access, adult content prompts and one of the three observation states. Keep learner's own Did it help? response on the dedicated card, plus first try, NS/reply and follow-up. A scribe can preserve feedback but cannot substitute for action.

Judgement

After teaching and a general task cue, observe the learner choose/start/use their selected routine with their card, visible model and usual aids, without adult step-by-step content prompts. Record what was actually seen and any prompts. A scribe may record a choice or reflection but cannot substitute for the learner using a routine. Choosing to stop or seek help is respected; do not invent completed practice or claim independence when adult step cues were needed.

Three recording states: Used steps with card/usual aids and no adult step prompts; Used steps with adult step prompts; Practice not observed this time. Observe only what is visible/known; a card on the desk alone does not prove use. Do not monitor or grade breath depth/rate, bodily appearance or health. Earlier supported teaching and later observed use are recorded separately.

Feedback and marking

One next step might use the chosen card's first step or ask for an agreed access change. Keep first try and reply separate. VF spoken feedback; WS with support; I own use without adult next-step cues; NS next step; // self-edit; ? read back; E actual saved evidence. R only after Voice, Audience, NS and response in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode.

Evidence record

Evidence Sheet page 1 is pupil guidance; page 2 private staff record with fourteen blank entry rows and exact disclosure note. Dedicated keep card is Support page 4, with choice/feedback initially blank. Adult may faithfully mark a choice or feedback given by learner, never fill it from an assumption. Offer to Communication portfolio; staff confirm mapping.

Continuity

Week 3 formative; Week 6 assessing. Builds on naming feelings/help by teaching and observing a chosen routine, without requiring distress. Existing school-agreed routines and access only; no treatment or guaranteed calming claim.

Scope

Only BUILD RSHE Spring 1 Week 3 authored. No later weeks or separate RSE content. Pause for Downloaded.

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